Unami Lodge, One LEC February Meeting Minutes
25, February, 2025
Cradle of Liberty Council #525
Reading the Vote final numbers: Yay/Nay/Abstain/No vote

Opening

Attendance: Larry Arinsberg, Sarah Olijnyk-Wong, Luke Smallberger, Emma Toombs, Liam Lynch, Bob Deck, Matt Rouleau, Paul Bowman, Brian Darcas, Chris Stasen, Zachary Gilinger, Marina Darcas, Alex Rossi, Griffen OBrien, Douglas LeBlanc, Gabe Oberholzer, Nicole Quinn, Jaclyn Keyser, Michael Gilinger, Brett Montich, Natalie Sidlow, Cullen Dougherty, Ian Brumm, Avery Tyrrell, Alexandra Smallberger, John Bickel, Andrew Barnett, Todge Sutkowski, Martin Stacey, Glen Campbell, Matt Gutterman

Motion: - Luke Smallberger: I would like to make a motion to approve last month's meeting minutes. Seconded Matt Rouleau by: PASSED

Committee Reports:

- AIA (Cullen Dougherty)
    - No Report Submitted
- Brotherhood (Griffen O'Brien)
    - All is well this month with the Brotherhood committee, we will meet later this month to discuss any weekend prep, and make sure the committee is keen with the schedule for the weekend! We will also check with Mr Bickle to make sure a place and date is locked in for the Blitz on the council calendar.
- Camp Promotions (Amelia LeVay)
    - No Report Submitted
- Ceremonies (Noah Goldberg)
    - No Report Submitted
- Communications (Nathan Schooler)
    - No Report Submitted
- Conclave (Skye Kramer)
    - Please consider purchasing one of our fundraiser items to help us keep our prices down. Our fundraiser items include a patch set ($20) and a dri-fit long sleeve ($30) which you can purchase at weekends and on our online trading post! For those of you attending conclave this year remember to put April 27th @7:30pm on your calendar for a virtual informational session. As always if you have any questions please reach out to the Conclave Committee at conclave@unamilodge.org!
- Events (Leah Callahan)
    - No Report Submitted
- History (Aidan Sutkowski / Marty Reph)
    - No Report Submitted
- Inductions (Jaclyn Keyser)

    - Our main focus as the committee is to establish a formal extended elangomat program that will continuously increase conversion rates and retention rates in the lodge. While the formation of the extended elangomat program is our priority currently, we also plan to help the ordeal and brotherhood committees as we did last year. This includes obtaining emats who want to do only the weekend, creating crews, and assisting in the ordeal projects. Please reach out to inductions@unamilodge.org for any further information.

    - Elangomat Interest form: https://forms.gle/i9CXwRzeekLQvx3L6

- LLD (Matt Rouleau)
    - Polestar planning is in the works, check your emails sometime in the future for a registration link (this is a closed event, only those invited will be able to sign up).
- Lodge Operations (Sophia Carrol)
    - No Report Submitted
- Membership (David Zangwill)
    - In 2024, we had 1003 members. February's not even over yet and we already have over half that, with 551 members in good standing. Of them, 172 are youth, 66 are young adults, and 313 are adults. We have 164 ordeals, 275 brotherhoods, and 109 vigils. Remember to pay your dues so we can increase those numbers!
- NOAC (Will Beardsley)
    - No Report Submitted
- Officers (Martin Stacey)
    - No Report Submitted
- Ordeal (Andrew Smallberger)
    - No Report Submitted
- Service (Ian Brumm)
    - The service committee would like to report that we are having a community service day THIS WEEKEND at MUSSER scout reservation. There are emails out and sign up is still open. For more information as well as the sign up link, check the email that was sent out.

    - In addition, the Service Committee is having another community service day at Mt. Moriah and Pennypack Park on March 22nd. The registration and further information was sent out in an email and will be resent out as the date approaches.
- Unit Elections (Marina Darcas / Douglas LeBlanc)
    - Saturday February 22nd unit elections training went extremely well with 38 in attendance representing all 11 chapters.
    - Unit elections are currently at 35% scheduled and 17% completed this includes 74 ordeals elected.

    - Unit elections trained patches have been ordered and they will be in by March 24th.
- Unit Representative (Douglas LeBlanc / Marina Darcas)
    - No Report Submitted
- Vigil Honor (Zach Kline)
    - Vigil nominations are open. Submit a worthy brother today.

Chapter Reports:

- Baden Powell (Dalton Samuel) [Y:A:]
    - No Report Submitted
- Conestoga (-) [Y:A:]
    - No Report Submitted
- Constellation (Christopher Stasen) [Y:A:]
    - No Report Submitted
- Continental (Mathew Yankowski) [Y:A:]
    - No report submitted
- General Nash (Brayden Leibel) [Y:A:]
    - No Report Submitted
- Lafayette (Douglas LeBlanc) [Y:A:]
    - No Report Submitted
- Minquas (Gabe Oberholzer) [Y:A:]
    - No Report Submitted
- Northern (Cullen Dougherty) [Y:A:]
    - No Report Submitted
- Roosevelt (-) [Y:A:]
    - No Report Submitted
- Triune (Amelia Levay) [Y:A:]
    - No Report Submitted
- Washington (Aidan Porter) [Y:A:]
    - No Report Submitted

Reports

Brotherhood (Griffen O'Brien) - All is well this month with the Brotherhood committee, we will meet later this month to discuss any weekend prep, and make sure the committee is keen with the schedule for the weekend! We will also check with Mr Bickle to make sure a place and date is locked in for the Blitz on the council calendar.

Inductions (Jaclyn Keyser) - Our main focus as the committee is to establish a formal extended elangomat program that will continuously increase conversion rates and retention rates in the lodge. While the formation of the extended elangomat program is our priority currently, we also plan to help the ordeal and brotherhood committees as we did last year. This

includes obtaining emats who want to do only the weekend, creating crews, and assisting in the ordeal projects. Please reach out to inductions@unamilodge.org for any further information.

Elangomat Interest form: https://forms.gle/i9CXwRzeekLQvx3L6

Membership (Luke Smallberger) - In 2024, we had 1003 members. February's not even over yet and we already have over half that, with 551 members in good standing. Of them, 172 are youth, 66 are young adults, and 313 are adults. We have 164 ordeals, 275 brotherhoods, and 109 vigils. Remember to pay your dues so we can increase those numbers!

Service (Ian Brumm) - The service committee would like to report that we are having a community service day THIS WEEKEND at MUSSER scout reservation. There are emails out and sign up is still open. For more information as well as the sign up link, check the email that was sent out.

Unit Elections (Marina Darcas) - The Unit Elections Training went extremely well with 38 members in attendance representing all 11 chapters. Unit elections are currently at 35% scheduled and 17% completed this includes 74 ordeals elected. The Unit elections trained patches have been ordered and they will be in by March 24th.

Business

Lafayette Chapter Patch (Douglas LeBlanc)

We are presenting two different variants of our proposed patch design. To start off this is the previous patch from 2015 (*See attached PDF*). The last chapter patch we had was 10 years ago, so we decided to make a newer one. This new design (*See attachment*) is different from other Chapter patches because it is based off of the Lafayette District shield. We plan to purchase 250 patches and sell them for $5.00 each. After we sell 97 patches the lodge will break even and the remaining sold patches will be a lodge profit. We'd like the lodge to pay for the initial purchase of patches. The numbers we have for the quantity of patches is based on the membership numbers in the chapter, we plan on buying additional patches for extra for future purchase.

The patches cost $2.31 each, If we bought 200 the total cost would be $482 including $20 for shipping, this would be a profit to the lodge of $518. If we bought 250 patches the total would be $597.50 including shipping, this would be a profit to the lodge of $652.50. We will be going back to chapter after final decision on patch design from LEC.

Paul Siminuk - 155 people paid dues in 2024 for Lafayette, that does not mean that all of them are going to purchase the patch. That being said I would suggest you start off with 200 patches and you can always buy more if needed. You also should reach out to the Treasurer of the lodge as this will become a lodge property.

Motion: Discussion Tabled to Next LEC

Spring service One Budget (Leah Callahan)

*See Budget

We are planning on having 260 members in attendance at Spring Service one. Estimated 75 Ordeal candidates at $50 each will be $3,750. For Brotherhood we are predicting 40 candidates at $50 each, for a total of $2,000. General members, we plan on having 115 General members for a total of $4,600, at $40 each. The income from the Turtle Pass is 30 members for $36.66 each, adding up to $1,099.80. The History Committee is allotting $225 for us to use for the Booklets / Handbooks. Our total estimated income comes out to $11,674.80.

We are purchasing 300 event patches at $1.91 each for a total cost of $573. Then weekend bracelets are $52.00 but they are already purchased. For the program our Amazon total is $769.80 to make the budget even out. Food for the weekend is going to cost us $7,460. For the Ordeal it is going to run about $2,100, and the sashes are $18 for the sash order. Brotherhood sashes are $18 each and assuming 40 Brotherhood candidates participate we will spend $720 on the sashes. Expenses total up to $11,674.80. This would make us break even with no profit or loss.

To make sure that we spend less on weekends we are continuing to have the usual patch auction. We will be having incentives including the materials, we plan to do clay pots, soccer and bingo.

Additionally for this year History is paying up to $1,000 for the OA Handbooks.

Motion: Leah Callahan - I would like to make a motion to approve the 2025 Spring Service One Budget. Seconded by: Chris Stasen: PASSED

2025 Events Patches (Leah Callahan)

*See Attachment For Patches

This year's grand theme is Around the World. Spring Service one the theme is Netherlands, spring Service Two is Australia, Summer inductions is Brazil, Fall Fellowship is Japan, and the Lodge Dinner is Italian themed. The patches have many colors and references to their designated themes. The Lodge Dinner patch is a passport. These patches do not form one big patch / set because Summer Inductions is going to have a limited attendance and we don't want to make it so many people will be missing one piece of the set.

We do need to add on the year because the set will be for this year. If we need to have the colors adjusted because there are many of them we will try to work something out or see if the

patch company can help with any of it.

Motion: Leah Callahan - I would like to make a motion to approve 2025 events Patches with changes of date. Seconded by Avery Tyrell: PASSED

Lodge Nametags (Luke Smallberger)

I got this idea because as a member of campstaff we always got new name tags each year. They were more modern and looked better than the last. This was something I thought of at LLD because the current name tag is kind of dated, it's almost 10 years old. Me and Mr. Gutterman has been working on a bunch of designs, working with the other officers, for LEC and we chose to go with this one (See Attachment for Concept). The examples show what they would look like with the Names, positions, and designs.

We are thinking about allowing General members to order name tags for themselves. With how printing the name tags work we would need an order of at least 12 name tags to be able to print them due to how many prints at a time, unless they want to pay for the additional material that would be used. There is an idea that we can have preorders and showcase the idea at the Lodge weekends. We could make a new design to separate the LEC name tag and the General members name tag.

Motion: Luke Smallberger - I would like to make a motion to approve the use of the turtle on new design. Seconded by Marina Darcas: PASSED

AIA Discussion (Cullen Dougherty)

*See Attached presentation

National has given out the current, but potentially changing, timeline for the removal of the AIA relations in the Induction ceremonies. There are 4 main key events that will move into play in this process. Step 1 already happened which is the introduction of the changes. Step 2 will occur between January and June in 2025, National will give lodges instructions on how they can continue some aspects, and they will disperse information about revamped ceremonies and handbooks. Step 3 will be the changes made to the induction process. In the final step all legacy content will be removed including ceremonies, legends, and other affiliated AIA content.

This means there is an approved separation of the AIA from ceremonies which means that we will not be allowed to have any more regalia, no language, or references in the induction ceremonies. There will be a new ceremony script approved by national and lodges must discontinue the current ceremonies at the end of 2025. We are allowed to use the current

ceremony for the remainder of 2025, but on January 1st of 2026 the new ceremony will go into place. Martin will receive more information about this process at NCOC in Philmont. These changes do not mean that AIA is gone entirely, it just removes it from the ceremonies and induction processes. We are here today to find out if we want to keep the traditions that we can and gauge interest on who is interested in continuing to have AIA in our program.

Lodges will be required to have a legal contract with State or Federally recognized tribes to continue to have AIA affiliation. If a lodge does not have a legal document then they must get rid of all AIA from lodge activities. There have been discussions of the new ceremonies having old Scout uniforms or all black dress attire.

The ceremonies will be revised in early 2025 to remove the AIA topics and lodges will be required to remove AIA from ceremonies before 2026. This includes drums, regalia, and all other aspects. We are still unsure of what ceremonies will look like in 2026. But our goal is that at the start of 2026 when we switch over to the new ceremonies our ceremonialists will have time to learn the new scripts.

So you may be thinking, why are we doing this? National change to honor the Native American culture. Now only state and federally recognized tribes can give approval to have AIA topics in lodges. Some of the tribes around us either aren't recognized or are just organizations with ties to tribes which do not count.

We are currently unaware of who we will seek out a contract to because we must be under the right legal documents. Do we want to pursue native traditions in the lodge? This will create a different experience for newly inducted candidates, there will be no AIA in ceremonies, but they can learn through pow wows, drum circles, and history talks. We use these events to spread the tradition and culture to new people to show the history and what the ceremony committee members have learned.

Motion: Cullen Dougherty - I would like to make a motion to approve Unami Lodge, One to pursue a written agreement with one of the federally or state recognized tribes. Seconded by Ian Brumm: PASSED

<u>Anything for the good of the Lodge</u>:

Gregg Slocum - Jeff Aster flaps are officially in and we have them for sale here tonight at LEC. Along with that we also have the Vigil Honor patches that are also for sale tonight.

Larry Neibauer - The Annual Council Dinner is on April 28th, 2025. We have one youth table and one adult table reserved. It's free for the youth and adults will have to pay a fee of $50.

Ian Brumm - Please sign up for the Musser Service Day this weekend on March 1st. Also I recommend signing up for the Community Service Day, we have multiple service days coming up in the next couple weeks.

Lodge Staff Advisor Minute: John Bickel

Two things to mention, it's great to hear the conversations between the youth. Its good that they are talking through bigger issues, so congratulations. Second of all as Unami Lodge, One we are based on the values of Brotherhood and Cheerful Service. Service is big, please help at the council level. Welcome people back or to the lodge events for service. We need people with special skills for bigger and specific council projects at the camps. If you know someone who is a professional like plumbing, roofing, etc, please invite them to camp projects or even to help at the lodge level. Invite new members with skills to weekends. Call to everybody, to people who might have skills, or new members that do. Connect them to me or the Rangers at the camps.

Lodge Adviser Minute: Todge Sutkowski

Usually Lodge Advisor minutes are supposed to be positive. But i'm going to start out negative to grab attention. Regarding membership, 184 people were inducted at SS1, SS2, and Summer Inductions, as of monday only 57 had paid their dues. This can have a big impact on our PMP points. We need a new member experience, we have a mission that we need to have better percentages with the extended elangomat process.

I'm going to share a Chinese quote: The journey of 1,000 steps starts with little steps. Make sure you are setting goals, personal goals in life, college, for Eagle Scout, for the workforce. Think where you want to be in 5 years, translate that to the lodge. Think how you can make that better moving forward in the lodge. Act upon actions, if you don't bring your scoutbook to meetings and you get a written test, you are not going to do good because you had no action to bring your scoutbook to the meetings. Life is a spectator event, act upon it, step by step move forwards and continue to act upon it. Big goals can be disheartening, keep taking those steps towards them. As an NYLT phrase: How do you eat an elephant? One bite at a time.

Chief Minute: Martin Stacey

Although parts of our ceremonies are changing, I want to remind you all that we are all still arrowmen. And although some of our core principles of the OA will be altered, that does not change the fact that we are still The Brotherhood of Cheerful Service. We are still arrowmen,

and we are still Unami. As someone who has applied the meaning of these ceremonies into my daily life, and strived to understand its meanings to its full potential, there is still no doubt in my mind that Unami will still strive to be what it always has been, the founding lodge of our society of honored campers. This means that we as arrowmen on the LEC may have our differences. We may argue, and we will definitely disagree. But at the end of the day, it is simply because we are so passionate for what we do in Unami. I want to reassure you all as your Chief that Unami will still continue to create high-performing arrowmen and serve as one of the most successful and role model lodges in the country; but this is only possible if we, as the members continue to serve our lodge, allow our Committees and chapters to grow, and to let newer arrowmen eventually pass the torch. There is no doubt in my mind that we will still be number ONE.

Closing and Song

Voting during the LEC

Quorum:
To make a motion- 60% of voting members must be present (20 of 33)
To pass a motion- 50% + 1 of present voting members must vote yay (18 for a full LEC)

Yay/Nay/Abstain/No vote
Y=Yay N=Nay A=Abstain -= No vote

Motions:

- Motion: - Luke Smallberger: I would like to make a motion to approve last month's meeting minutes. Seconded Matt Rouleau by: PASSED
- Motion: Leah Callahan - I would like to make a motion to approve the 2025 Spring Service One Budget. Seconded by: Chris Stasen: PASSED
- Motion: Leah Callahan - I would like to make a motion to approve 2025 events Patches with changes of date. Seconded by Avery Tyrell: PASSED
- Motion: Luke Smallberger - I would like to make a motion to approve the use of the turtle on new design. Seconded by Marina Darcas: PASSED
- Motion: Cullen Dougherty - I would like to make a motion to approve Unami Lodge, One to pursue a written agreement with one of the federally or state recognized tribes. Seconded by Ian Brumm: PASSED

Committee/Chapter	**Vote**
Vice Chief 1	yyyyy
Vice Chief 2	yyyyy
Secretary	yyyyy
Treasurer	-----
American Indian Affairs	yyyyy
Brotherhood	yyyyy
Camp Promotions	yyyyy
Ceremonies	-----
Communications	yyyyy
Conclave	-----

Events	yyyyy
History	-yyyy
Inductions	yyyyy
Lodge Leadership Development	yyyyy
Lodge Operations	yyyyy
Membership	-----
NOAC	-----
Ordeal	-yyyy
Service	yyyyy
Unit Elections	yyyyy
Unit Representative	-yyyy
Vigil Honor	yyyyy
Immediate Past Chief	-yyyy
Baden Powell	yyyyy
Conestoga	-----
Constellation	yyyyy
Continental	-----
General Nash	yyyyy
Lafayette	yyyyy
Minquas	yyyyy
Northern	yyyyy
Roosevelt	-----
Triune	-yyyy
Washington	yyyyy

Lodge Chief (Only in the event of a tie)	